

Hormones in action

There are more than 50 hormones in the body. Each controls a different activity, such as reacting to danger, triggering growth, and managing fuel supplies for energy.

Hormone rush

The hormone epinephrine is released to help people face or flee from danger. This fast-acting hormone increases the heart and breathing rates, fuel supply, and blood flow to the muscles.



Growing up

Released by the pituitary gland, growth hormone (GH) makes a child's bones grow longer. Growth happens when new bone tissue is added at the ends of bones. Bones stop growing in adults.



X-ray showing a child's hand bones



X-ray showing an adult's hand bones

Free-fall skydiving is exciting but scary and causes a rush of epinephrine